

count for 75 per cent of the country's 3G connections by 2015. Even though initial 3G rollouts are concentrated in the so-called metro areas (Mumbai, Delhi, Chennai and Kolkata), they will soon be outstripped by the fast-growing demand for 3G in more populous regions like Punjab, Bihar, Andhra Pradesh and Haryana.

Smart card market in India to see sharp rise

With the Indian government undertaking various programmes like the Rashtriya Swasthya Bima Yojana, the National Rural Employment Guarantee Act and the Public Distribution System, there is sure to be an upsurge in the adoption of smart card technology in India.

"Under the programme for below-poverty-line (BPL) families, the government has already issued close to 180 million smart cards and there is a potential for over 300 million cards still to be issued/reissued to these families. As part of this programme, BPL families can enjoy cashless medical treatment of up to Rs 30,000 per annum," says Anil Agarwal, director, ID Smart Cards Creations.

Smart cards are gaining popularity in many other applications as well. According to Deepak Agarwal, senior manager, technical marketing, Secure Micros, STMicroelectronics, "Telecom market in India is already booming and with the 3G spectrum opening up, there will be yet more expansion as the requirement of SIM cards will increase. Further, the penetration of mobile phones in rural areas will result in growth in the telecom sector. We foresee a higher demand for smart cards in this segment."

Banking is another sector where the demand for smart cards is rising as smart cards are slowly changing over from being made of magnetic strip cards to being chip based or a combination of the two.

E-mail and SMS preferred by leading marketers

With the growth in the digital medium

Calendar of Forthcoming Electronics Fairs/Exhibitions/Seminars

Name, Date and Venue	Topics to be covered	Contact address for details
Display March 29, 2011 Paris Porte de Versailles Paris, France	13th edition of exhibition of electronic visual display technologies	Infopromotions 97, Street of Seek, Middel, Paris, France Fax: +(33)-(1)-45443040 Phone: +(33)-(1)-44398500
ICVCI 2011 April 7-9, 2011 SAINTGITS College of Engineering, Kottayam, Kerala	International conference on VLSI, communication and instrumentation	Organising Secretary, ICVCI 2011 SAINTGITS College of Engineering Kottukulam Hills, Pathamuttom (P.O) Kottayam District, Kerala E-mail: icvci2011@saingits.org Web: http://icvci.org
Touch Panel Japan April 13-15, 2011 Tokyo International Exhibition Center (Tokyo Big Sight) Tokyo, Japan	Event for electronic devices including consumer electronics	Reed Exhibitions Japan Limited 18F Shinjuku-Nomura Building 1-26-2 Nishishinjuku, Shinjuku, Tokyo, Japan Fax: +(81)-(3)-33498599 Phone: +(81)-(3)-33498501
Hong Kong Electronics Fair April 13-16, 2011 Hong Kong Convention & Exhibition Centre (HKCEC) Hong Kong, China	Fair for components, assemblies, electronics production and display technologies in Asia	Exhibitions Department Hong Kong Trade Development Council Unit 13, Expo Galleria Hong Kong Convention and Exhibition Centre Wan Chai, Hong Kong Fax: (852) 2824 0026; Phone: 1830 668 E-mail: exhibitions@hktdc.org Web: hktdc.com/hkelectronicfair
Expo Electronica April 19-21, 2011 Crocus Expo International Exhibition Center Moscow, Russia	International exhibition of electronic components and technological equipment	Primexpo Saint Petersburg, 24-A, Yakubovicha Street 3rd Floor, Belye Nochi, Russia Fax: (7)-(812)-3806001 Phone: (7)-(812)-3806002, 3806000
Semicon Singapore May 11-13, 2011 Suntec Singapore International Convention & Exhibition Centre Singapore	Southeast Asia's premier event for showcasing the latest semiconductor manufacturing technology	Semiconductor Equipment & Materials Institute 3081 Zanker Road, San Jose, USA Fax: +(1) (408) 4289600 Phone: 9436900
EduTech Expo 2011 Guwahati: May 14-15, 2011 Patna: May 21-22, 2011 Cochin: May 28-29, 2011 Pune: June 4-5, 2011 Indore: June 11-12, 2011 Dharamshala: June 18-19, 2011 New Delhi: June 25-26, 2011	6th education fair of technical courses in India	Rajesh Singh (Mobile: 09212152180) Dinesh Pant (Mobile: 09971991814) EFY Enterprises Pvt Ltd D-87/1, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase 1 New Delhi 110020 Phone: (011) 26810601/02/03
RENEWCON Wind India 2011 May 19-20, 2011 ITC Maratha, Mumbai, India	Conference bringing together key government and regulatory officials, power generation players, equipment and component providers, scientific and R&D experts for business-critical insights, case studies and expert advice on making wind power projects pay	Karthik Rajaraman, Programme Manager The Energy Business Conferences UBM India Pvt Ltd, Mumbai Fax: (022) 40461477 Phone: 40461466 E-mail: conferences@ubmindia.com Web: www.renewconwind-india.com
BroadcastAsia2011 June 21-24, 2011 Suntec Singapore	The 16th international digital multimedia and entertainment technology exhibition and conference	Singapore Exhibition Services Pte Ltd 1, Jalan Klang Timur, #09-02 Pacific Tech Centre Singapore 159303 Fax: +65 6233 6633; Phone: +65 6233 6638 Web: www.broadcast-asia.com
RFidIndia Expo 2011 SmartCards Expo 2011 e-Security Expo 2011 BiometricsIndia Expo 2011 e-PaymentsIndia Expo 2011 September 28-30, 2011 Pragati Maidan, New Delhi	International conference and exhibition of related technology and applications	Electronics Today 104, Andheri Industrial Estate Off. Veera Desai Road, Andheri (W) Mumbai 400053 Phone: (022) 26730869-72 E-mail: elctoday@vsnl.net Web: www.electronicstoday.org

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